

Desk Research Template

[Project Name] | [Project subheading]

The Hypothesis <i>If/Then format: "If we provide [X], then [buyer] will [measurable outcome]."</i> <i>Who is the buyer? What is the burning problem? What's the measurable change you create?</i>	Time Budget Market Research: ~4 hrs Competitor Audit: ~4 hrs Hypothesis & UVP: ~4 hrs Total: ~12 hrs Actual time spent:
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Market Overview ⌚ ~4 hrs

TAM — Total Addressable Market <i>How big is the universe? All orgs / people who could ever need this.</i>	SAM — Serviceable Market <i>Of that universe, who can you realistically reach given your model, geography, and capacity?</i>	SOM — Share of Market <i>In the next 1–2 years, what slice could you actually capture? What's the revenue potential?</i>
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Where does the money come from? Grants, org budgets, individual spend, government? Segment by behavior — who is desperately looking for this vs. who would be mildly interested?

Thrive Mission Alignment

Alignment with Thrive's mission is the north star. Document your thinking here before moving into competitive and customer research.	
How does this scale the reach of Thrive's mission? <i>Who does it serve? How does it extend Thrive's impact beyond what we currently do?</i> <i>Does it deepen or broaden our existing work?</i> <i>Is Thrive positioned and ready to take this on?</i>	Where could this go counter to the mission? <i>Are there populations, approaches, or partnerships that could create tension or conflict?</i> <i>What would need to be true for this to stay in bounds?</i> <i>Does this need to be surfaced internally before moving forward?</i>

Competitor Landscape ⌚ ~4 hrs <i>Direct competitors: who is already selling this?</i> <i>Adjacent solutions: what do buyers use that partially solves this?</i> <i>Workarounds: spreadsheets, group texts, informal processes — these are your real competition.</i> <i>Where does 'do nothing' fit on the spectrum?</i>	User / Payor / Referrer Map <i>Who actually uses it day-to-day?</i> <i>Who controls the budget and signs the check?</i> <i>Who recommends or refers buyers to solutions like this?</i> <i>Are these the same person or different? If different — who do you sell to first?</i>
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UVP Hypothesis ⌚ ~4 hrs	Unique Advantages <i>Network trust and relationships — who do we know?</i>
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Among all the ways this problem gets solved, why is our approach distinct?
Do our 'pain relievers' match their actual 'pains'? Use Value Proposition Canvas.
What's the demonstrable difference vs. the next best alternative?

Outcomes orientation — does the market signal they care about this?
Timing, credentials, access — what do we have that others don't?

Open Questions & Riskiest Assumptions

What do you still not know? What, if wrong, would kill this idea? List your top 3–5 assumptions to test in customer discovery.
